

KB-007-App-Account-Issues

KB-007 — App, Account & RFID Card Issues

Category: Authentication & Account
Call Volume: ~9% of contacts
Resolution Rate on Call: ~85%
Primary Remote Actions: Password reset, RFID card activation, account lookup

Why This Matters

App and account issues gate everything else — a driver who can’t authenticate can’t start a session regardless of charger health. These issues are often quick to resolve but require careful verification to avoid account security risks. RFID card issues are especially common among fleet drivers and corporate accounts who use physical cards rather than the app.

Background: Authentication Methods

Most EV charging networks support multiple ways to authenticate and start a session:

Method	How it works	Common issues
Network app	Driver opens the app, selects station, taps Start	Login failures, app crashes, stale session
RFID card	Tap physical card against reader	Card not registered, card inactive, reader fault
Tap-to-pay	Tap contactless credit/debit against payment reader	Timeout, bank block, unsupported card
QR code / guest checkout	Scan QR on charger, pay as guest	Varies by station; no account required

Method	How it works	Common issues
Plug-and-charge (ISO 15118)	Vehicle auto-authenticates when cable inserted	Vehicle must support; requires pre-enrollment
Phone number / SMS code	Some networks send a one-time code via SMS	Delivery delay, wrong number on file

Section A — App Issues

Problem: Driver Can't Log In

Step 1 — Identify the failure type

“What happens when you try to log in — do you get an error message, or does it just not respond?”

Symptom	Likely cause
“Invalid password”	Wrong password; needs reset
“Account not found”	Wrong email address; or account doesn't exist
“Account locked”	Too many failed attempts
App crashes on login	App bug; try update or reinstall
Loads but says “session expired”	Token expired; force logout and back in
Email/password correct but 2FA isn't coming	SMS delivery issue or wrong number on file

Step 2 — Password reset

“Let me send a password reset to your email. What address do you have on file with us?”

Look up the account to confirm the email is active before sending the reset.

“I've sent a reset link — it should arrive within a minute or two. If you don't see it, check your spam folder. The link expires in 24 hours.”

If the driver doesn't have access to the email on file: > “I can update your email address, but I'll need to verify your identity first. Can you confirm your name and the last 4 digits of the card on file with us?”

After identity verification, update the email and resend the reset.

Step 3 — Account locked

If the account is locked due to too many failed login attempts: > “Your account has been temporarily locked for security. I can unlock it right now — give me just a moment.”

Unlock the account in the backend. Then: > “I’ve unlocked it. Try logging in again, and if you’re not sure of your password, let me send a reset link too.”

Step 4 — Account not found

“I’m not finding an account with that email. Is it possible you signed up with a different address, or through a third-party like Google or Apple sign-in?”

Check for: - Common email typos (gamil vs. gmail, .con vs. .com) - Social login (Google, Apple, Facebook) — the account may exist but be linked to a social provider, not a password - A different email format (firstname.lastname vs. first_last, etc.)

If genuinely no account exists: > “It doesn’t look like there’s an account with that email. You can sign up in the app in about a minute — or if you need to charge right now, most of our stations accept a credit card tap directly, no account needed.”

Problem: App Won’t Start a Session (Account OK, Login Fine)

Step 1 — Verify the app version Outdated apps can fail to communicate with updated backends.

“Quick check — when did you last update the app? It’s worth checking if there’s an update available in the App Store or Google Play.”

Step 2 — Force close and reopen

“Try fully closing the app — don’t just minimize it — and reopening it. Then try starting the session again.”

Step 3 — Check location permissions

Many network apps require location access to confirm the driver is near the station before authorizing a session.

“Can you check that the app has permission to access your location? That’s sometimes required to start a session. You can find it in your phone’s Settings under the app name.”

Step 4 — Clear app cache (Android) or reinstall (iOS/Android)

If none of the above work:

“Try uninstalling the app and reinstalling it fresh. That clears any corrupted data that might be blocking it. Your account and payment info are stored on our servers, so you won’t lose anything.”

Step 5 — Use alternative method

“While we sort this out — you can also start the session by tapping your credit card directly on the station reader. Would you like to try that?”

Problem: App Shows Wrong Charger Status / Map Not Updating

Stale app data — see KB-004 for full context. Short version:

“The app’s map can sometimes lag behind real-time status. Let me check the actual live status on our end and tell you what it’s really showing.”

Advise driver to pull-to-refresh or toggle location off/on to force a map refresh. If the app consistently shows wrong data, clearing the cache or reinstalling helps.

Section B — RFID Card Issues

Problem: RFID Card Won’t Work at the Reader

Step 1 — Check card status in backend

Look up the card number (usually printed on the card or the card packaging).

Backend status	Action
Active, registered to account	Likely a tap technique issue or reader fault
Inactive	Activate the card
Not found / unregistered	Register the card to the driver’s account
Suspended	Cannot reactivate without Tier 2 review — escalate
Expired	Issue a replacement card

Step 2 — Tap technique (if card is active)

Most RFID card failures are technique issues:

“Try holding the card flat against the reader — not at an angle — for a full 3 to 5 seconds. It should beep or flash when it reads. A quick tap sometimes isn’t long enough.”

Also: - Ensure no other RFID cards (bank cards, access badges) are stacked behind the charging card — they interfere with each other - The card should be presented to the specific reader zone, usually marked with a contactless payment icon or RFID wave symbol - Some readers require the card to be within 2–3 cm (about 1 inch)

Step 3 — Reader fault

If the card is confirmed active and tap technique is correct, the reader may have a hardware fault.

“Your card looks active and correct on our end. If it’s still not reading, the RFID reader on that specific unit may have a fault. You can try starting via the app or tapping a credit card directly as an alternative, and I’ll flag the reader for inspection.”

Problem: RFID Card Is Not Registered

Step 1 — Verify driver identity

Before linking a card to an account, verify: > “Can you confirm the email address on your account and the last 4 digits of the payment card on file?”

Step 2 — Register the card

Enter the RFID card number (printed on the card, usually 16–20 digits) into the account in the backend.

Step 3 — Confirm registration

“I’ve linked your RFID card to your account. Give it a try — tap it against the reader now.”

Problem: Fleet / Corporate RFID Account

Corporate accounts sometimes have different authorization flows: - Cards may be assigned to a specific vehicle, not a specific driver - Cards may have charging time restrictions or location restrictions - Cards may require a PIN - Cards may be managed by a fleet administrator who needs to activate or authorize them

“Your card is registered to a corporate fleet account. Changes to fleet cards typically need to go through your company’s fleet administrator — I can’t activate or modify fleet cards directly. I’d recommend contacting your fleet manager. As an alternative, you can use a personal payment method to charge today.”

Section C — Plug-and-Charge Setup Issues

Plug-and-charge (ISO 15118 protocol) automatically authenticates the session when the cable is inserted, without any app or card interaction. It requires: 1. The vehicle to support ISO 15118 (check manufacturer documentation) 2. The charging station to support ISO 15118 3. The driver to have enrolled their vehicle’s charging certificate with the network

Common issues:

Issue	Cause	Resolution
Plug-and-charge doesn’t start automatically	Vehicle not enrolled, or network not configured	Enroll vehicle via app settings, or use app/RFID for this session
Plug-and-charge authorizes to wrong account	Multiple accounts or vehicles configured	Review plug-and-charge settings in app
Plug-and-charge worked before, not now	Certificate may have expired	Re-enroll in app settings
Driver wants to disable plug-and-charge	Preference	Direct to app account settings

“Plug-and-charge requires a bit of setup — your vehicle’s certificate needs to be enrolled with our network. You can do that in the app under Account > Vehicles > Plug-and-Charge. For today’s session, try the app or card as a backup.”

Section D — Account Management on Call

Updating Payment Method

Do not update payment details over the phone — direct drivers to the app or web portal for PCI compliance.

“For your security, I can’t update card details over the phone. You can update your payment method in the app under Account > Payment — it only takes a minute.”

Account Closure

Treat account closure requests with care. Confirm identity first, then:

“I can close your account. Before I do, can I ask what prompted this? If there’s a specific issue, I’d like to see if we can resolve it. If you’d still like to close it, I’ll need to confirm your identity.”

Process: verify name, email, confirm any outstanding balance is settled, then initiate closure per standard process.

Transferring an Account to a New Email

Verify identity (name + last 4 of card on file), then update email in backend. Log the change.

Escalation Criteria

Condition	Action
Driver locked out and can't access email on file	Tier 2 identity verification
Suspected account compromise (unauthorized charges, unknown sessions)	Tier 2 immediately; advise driver to contact their bank
Fleet card issues	Direct to fleet administrator
Card suspended	Tier 2 review required to reinstate
Driver reports account was closed without their action	Tier 2 immediately — potential security incident

Agent Reminders

- Never update payment card details over the phone. Always direct to the app or web portal.
- Verify identity before making any account changes — name + email + last 4 of card on file is the minimum.
- If a driver says their account shows sessions they didn't initiate, treat this as a potential security incident — escalate to Tier 2 and advise them to contact their bank.
- RFID card technique is the most common fix. Don't skip it even if the driver sounds tech-savvy.
- Plug-and-charge is still not universal — not all vehicles or stations support it. Set correct expectations.